

architectural designs and product blueprints. By the end of this chapter, you'll be well equipped to begin using Google SketchUp. We'll start by introducing you to the interface, the tools, and how to basically get acquainted with the software. To begin, you'd obviously need the software installed. Before you begin, ensure that your system has at least the basic configurations listed on the previous page.

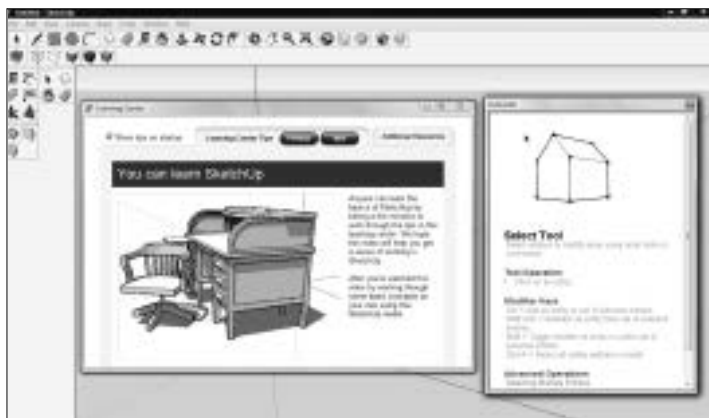
Other considerations to note:

- A Linux version of Google SketchUp isn't available at this time.
- Google SketchUp will run on multiple-processor machines, but will only use one thread on one processor. Google SketchUp doesn't support hyperthreading or multithreading at this time.

1.2 A Tour Of SketchUp's Interface

After installing Google SketchUp on your computer, double-click the appropriate icon (on your desktop or via Start > Programs > Google SketchUp) to start the program.

The first view you get on opening Google SketchUp for the first time is that of a dialog box asking you to choose your default settings for usage. You have a choice of view and system of units.



The Learning Centre and the Instructor